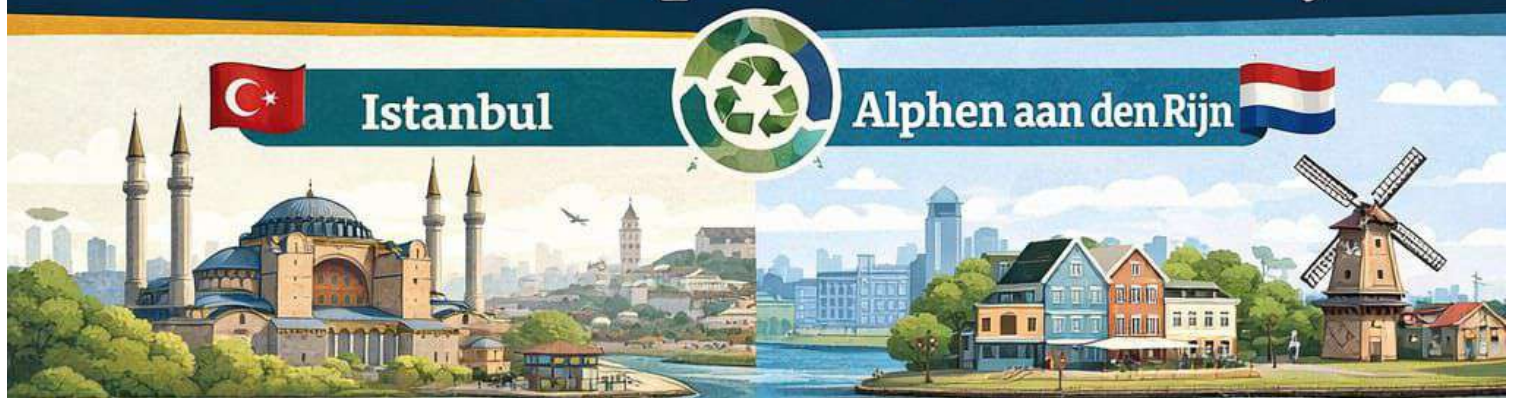


Public Waste Comparison: Istanbul vs Alphen aan den Rijn



Public Waste in Istanbul – Public Areas

What kind of trash is found?

- Plastic bottles and caps
- Disposable cups
- Food packaging (chips, candy, fast food)
- Cigarette butts



Where is the most trash found?

- Coastal areas and waterfronts
- Public transit stops (bus, metro, ferry stations)
- Parks and picnic areas
- Busy squares and tourist spots



How much trash is there?

- High in busy areas
- Increases on weekend and holidays



Recycling & deposit system

- No mandatory deposit system as in Holland.
- Some municipalities have limited reward-based return machines.



Public Waste in Alphen aan den Rijn – Public Areas

What kind of trash is found?

- Plastic bottles & cans
- Paper and cardboard packaging
- Drink cans
- Small amounts of food waste



Where is the most trash found?

- Near train stations
- Playgrounds
- Along bike paths and canals
- Near shopping centers



How much trash is there?

- Generally lower, limited due to regular cleaning & recycling system



Statiegeld system

- Mandatory deposit system in Netherlands.
- Pay deposit for plastic bottles & cans
- Get money back when bottle is returned

Istanbul

- ✓ **Trash Types:** Plastic, food packaging, cigarettes
- 📍 **Concentrated:** Coasts transit stops, parks
- ✓ **Trash Amount:** High (due to crowds)
- 🔔 **Deposit System:** Not common
- 🧹 **Cleaning System:** Public-based



Alphen aan den Rijn

- ✓ **Trash Types:** Plastic, paper, cans
- 📍 **Stations, parks**
- ✓ **Lower, controlled**
- 🔔 **Statiegeld active**
- 🧹 **Systematic + individual responsibility**



In both cities, public areas have waste problems, However, recycling systems, personal awareness, and deposit practices greatly influence the amount of trash.

LITTER IN PUBLIC SPACES

ISTANBUL VS. ALPHEN AAN DEN RIJN

1 Causes

Our only source of information about litter in Istanbul is the poster we received from our "project buddies." It didn't mention many causes for the litter on the streets.

Our own research has found reasons such as human behavior, a shortage of trash cans, and impractical trash cans.

We suspect the reasons are largely the same, as several are fairly self-evident. But this, of course, remains just a guess.

2 Consequences

The poster also doesn't mention much about the consequences of litter in Istanbul. The consequences we mention are plastic soup, the increased greenhouse effect, and animal suffering. Here too, the cities don't differ much.

A large river flows through both Istanbul and Alphen: the Bosphorus and other rivers in Istanbul, and the Rhine in Alphen. This exacerbates the impact on the plastic soup in both cities, because waste more easily ends up in the water.

The production of plastic for Istanbul is, of course, just as harmful as the production of plastic for Alphen. So the cities are certainly comparable in terms of this impact.

The animal suffering in Istanbul (presumably) mainly affects stray dogs and cats. In Alphen, it affects birds and aquatic animals more. Otherwise, the impact is reasonably comparable.

3 Solutions

The poster we received from Istanbul provided us with a wealth of information about litter management solutions there. This makes it easy to compare the topic.

It's quite clear that more is being done to combat litter in Alphen aan den Rijn than in Istanbul. In Istanbul, the "Statiegeld" system is the only current solution. However, Alphen is ahead of the curve in this regard as well, not only because there are more places to return bottles and cans, but also because the deposit is higher.

All other litter management solutions in Alphen are incomparable, simply because they aren't available in Istanbul or aren't mentioned in the poster.

4 General

The types of waste found in both cities are surprisingly similar. Cigarettes and food packaging are a major problem in both cities. Bottles and cans are also still common on the streets, despite the deposit system.

In Istanbul, most waste is found around transportation-related areas, such as train stations, and meeting places. This is exactly the same in Alphen aan den Rijn, making it easy to compare.

Public Waste in Istanbul

Public Areas



Istanbul

What kind of trash is found?

- Plastic bottles and caps
- Disposable cups
- Food packaging (chips, candy, fast food)
- Cigarette butts
- Paper and cardboard waste



Where is the most trash found?

- Coastal areas and waterfronts
- Public transit stops, (bus, metro, ferry stations)
- Parks and picnic areas
- Busy squares and tourist sites



Where is the most trash found?

- Coastal areas and waterfronts
- Public transit stops (bus, metro, ferry stations)
- Parks and picnic areas
- Busy squares and tourist sites



How much trash is there?

- Trash levels are higher in densely populated areas. Peaks are observed during weekends and holidays.
- Popular beaches.
- Main transit hubs.



Is there a recycling & deposit system?

- Turkey lacks a mandatory deposit system like in the Netherlands (**Statiegeld**). However:
- Some municipalities have limited **reward-based** return machines
- These machines give **transport credits** or small **rewards** for plastic bottles. Not **widespread**, mostly in central places



Conclusion: Istanbul's public areas face significant waste problems. Enhancing recycling initiatives and public awareness are crucial to addressing these issues.